



Sunflower Petals

Product Ideas and Focus Areas for Sunflower Petals

"Sunflower Petals" as a product line focused on Essential for Living (EFL) for individuals with special needs (Autism, ADHD, Learning Difficulties) can be structured around the core needs of self-regulation, sensory processing, and independent living.

ADL and IADL

The product line for Activities of Daily Living (ADL) and Instrumental Activities of Daily Living (IADL) will be developed using insights gained from the experiences of the Experience of Fluent Living (EFL) products response.

This document serves as a master repository of the ideas, justification, variations and feasibility with the cost and selling methodologies.

Core Product Focus Areas

1. **Sensory Regulation Tools:** Products designed to help individuals manage overstimulation or under-stimulation, aligning with the "Self-Care" aspect of EFL.
 - **Weighted Items:** Lap pads, shoulder wraps, or small plush toys that provide deep pressure input to promote calm and focus.

- **Fidget and Tactile Aids:** Discreet, non-distracting items with varied textures for fine motor stimulation and anxiety management.
 - **Visual/Auditory Tools:** Light-filtering sheets, noise-dampening ear defenders, or visual timers to manage environmental input.
2. **Organization and Routine Aids:** Products that support executive function and structure, critical for managing ADHD and learning difficulties.
- **Visual Schedules:** Modular and customizable magnetic or card-based systems for breaking down daily routines or complex tasks.
 - **Time Management Tools:** Color-coded timers and non-digital clocks that make the passage of time concrete and easy to understand.
 - **Storage Solutions:** Clearly labeled and visually organized storage units that simplify clean-up and object location.
3. **Skill-Building and Independence:** Physical products that facilitate the learning of practical, everyday skills (Essential for Living).
- **Fine Motor Task Boards:** Lacing, buttoning, zipping, and snapping practice boards incorporated into play-based tools.
 - **Adaptive Utensils/Grips:** Ergonomically designed aids for writing, eating, or self-grooming to reduce frustration and promote self-sufficiency.
 - **Sequencing Toys/Puzzles:** Multi-step activities that teach planning, order, and problem-solving.

Alignment with Special Needs

Special Need	Product Benefit	EFL Connection
Autism	Provides predictable sensory input and structure to reduce anxiety.	Self-Care & Safety: Tools for emotional regulation and safe engagement with the environment.
ADHD	Externalizes focus and routine, making abstract concepts like time and	Executive Function: Aids for planning, prioritizing, and maintaining attention for daily tasks.

	task completion concrete.	
Learning Difficulties	Offers hands-on, multi-sensory ways to practice foundational life skills.	Practical Skills: Supports the development of fine motor skills and independent living habits.
Others	...	...

Product philosophies

1. Each product should connect to a story and problem (eg. calendar for learning the sense of time)
2. Complexity Grading and Color coded as per the graded complexity

EFL, ADL and IADL

EFL - Essentials for Living

Essential for Living (EFL) focuses on the core, functional skills necessary for self-regulation, safety, communication, and independent living. *It defines the critical curriculum content for an individual's success and quality of life.*

ADL - Activities of Daily Living

These are the basic self-care tasks required for personal maintenance and well-being. *EFL directly addresses the teaching and mastery of these foundational skills.*

IADL - Instrumental Activities of Daily Living

These are the more complex tasks that allow an individual to live independently within a community. *EFL also targets these skills as they are essential for living a full life.*

The Learning Grid

Skill Category	Core Focus/Goal	Example Skills/Tasks
Essential for Living (EFL)	The foundational and critical skills required for an individual to have a safe, self-determined, and personally meaningful life. EFL is the overarching framework.	- Functional Communication (e.g., requesting, protesting, making choices), - Self-Regulation (e.g., managing sensory input, coping with anxiety), - Safety Skills (e.g., following emergency directions, identifying danger), - Self-Care (encompasses ADL).
Activities of Daily Living (ADL)	The basic and necessary skills for personal self-care and physical maintenance. These are foundational and typically learned first.	- Bathing or Showering, - Dressing (putting on and taking off clothes), - Toileting (continence and hygiene), - Feeding (bringing food to mouth), - Grooming (e.g., brushing teeth, combing hair), - Basic Mobility.

Instrumental Activities of Daily Living (IADL)	The more complex, life-management skills required to live independently within the community. These usually require more planning and executive function.	- Meal Preparation (planning, cooking, cleaning up), - Money Management (budgeting, paying bills), - Shopping (grocery or other necessary items), - Housework (laundry, cleaning), - Using Communication Devices (phone, computer), - Managing Medication, - Using Transportation.
---	--	---

Picture examples

EFL	ADL	IADL
		
A child with autism is shown using a set of noise-dampening ear defenders in a busy classroom environment.	A person is using a Fine Motor Task Board that has a large zipper, buttons, and snaps to practice getting dressed.	A young adult is shown standing at a kitchen counter, following a step-by-step visual sequence chart to prepare a simple snack.
Why does it represent the category ?		

This product addresses Self-Regulation, which is a core EFL skill. The ability to manage sensory input (like loud noise) is critical for emotional regulation, reducing anxiety, and safely engaging with the environment, all of which are foundational to a personally meaningful life.	This product directly teaches and supports Dressing, which is one of the basic, necessary skills for personal self-care and physical maintenance. ADL skills are foundational and typically learned first on the path to independence.	This activity demonstrates Meal Preparation, a more complex, life-management skill required to live independently within a community. IADL skills require planning, executive function, and the coordination of multiple steps, which is why they are often targeted after basic ADL skills are mastered.
--	---	--

Social of petals

Unboxing soon: Sunflower Petals. 🌻

What if learning didn't have to look a certain way?

What if it could feel like wonder... like discovery... like play?

Not everything meaningful fits into structure.

Some of the most important growth happens in the in-between
in moments of curiosity, in small explorations, in quiet joy.

Play is where expression begins,
where connection deepens,
where understanding gently takes shape.

When we loosen the rules,
we make space for confidence to grow naturally, freely.
Because nature was never meant to follow straight lines.

And neither are we. 🌻

This Autism Awareness Day, we're gently unfolding Sunflower Petals, an initiative under the Sunflower Institute for Autism.

A space where every mind blooms differently, and every way of learning is seen, valued, and supported.

Because:

Unstructured is the new structure.

Play is the new integration.

A new way to bloom is about to unfold.

Coming alive this April 2nd.

Let's grow together. 🧡

Together, holding the lantern high

for every sunflower that follows the light. ✨

[#SunflowerPetals](#) [#AutismAwarenessDay](#) [#Neurodiversity](#) [#PlayMatters](#)

Play isn't a break from learning.

It is the learning. 🌻

For too long, growth has been expected to follow straight lines be neatly structured, carefully measured. But real learning doesn't live in boxes. It unfolds in moments of curiosity, exploration, and play.

Play is how we explore, express, connect, and make sense of the world around us. When we embrace the unstructured, we create space for confidence to grow naturally through joy, not rigidity.

Nature doesn't grow in straight lines and neither do we. 🌻

This Autism Awareness Day, we're proud to introduce Sunflower Petals-an initiative under the [Sunflower Institute for Autism](#). A space built on the belief that every mind blooms differently, and every way of learning deserves to be understood.

Because:

Unstructured is the new structure.

Play is the new integration.

A new way to bloom is unfolding.

Going live on April 2nd - Autism Awareness Day

Let's grow together. 🧡

[#SunflowerPetals](#) [#AutismAwarenessDay](#) [#Neurodiversity](#) [#PlayMatters](#)